

Incident Runbook AI Powered Resume Screener

Severity	SEV 2 by default • Raise to SEV 1 for security, data-integrity, or broad service impact
Critical flow	Resume upload → Textract → Comprehend → SQS scoring → DynamoDB → recruiter dashboard

Alarm meaning Error-rate alarm: more than 5% Lambda errors for two consecutive 5-minute periods. Latency alarm: Lambda P95 duration above 3,000 ms for two consecutive 5-minute periods.

POSSIBLE CAUSES

- 401: missing/expired Cognito JWT; 403: recruiter group or route permission mismatch
- Unsupported, corrupt, encrypted, or oversized resume
- Textract/Comprehend throttling, timeout, quota, or malformed response
- SQS backlog, poison message, visibility mismatch, or DLQ growth
- DynamoDB AccessDenied/throttling or large OCR/NLP workload

BUSINESS IMPACT

Resumes may remain unprocessed, candidate profiles or rankings may be delayed/incomplete, recruiter decisions may use stale data, and processing cost may rise through repeated OCR/NLP calls.

FIRST RESPONSE

1. Acknowledge the alert; record job ID, document hash, message ID, correlation ID, region, and alarm.
2. For 401/403, validate JWT expiry/issuer/audience, recruiter group claim, Cognito authorizer, and route protection; GET /health is the public exception.
3. Locate the failed stage using metrics, logs, X-Ray, queue age/depth, and DLQ. Never log resume text or PII.
4. For AccessDenied, match the denied DynamoDB/S3/SQS action to the exact ARN; also validate KMS, quotas, visibility timeout, and retries.
5. Quarantine poison documents. Redrive only failed messages and use the document hash to avoid duplicate Textract/Comprehend charges.

RECOVERY VERIFICATION

- Process one safe test resume end to end and confirm a single candidate record and score.
- Verify queue depth/oldest age returns to normal and DLQ does not grow.
- Confirm recruiter dashboard fields populate and alarms stay OK for two periods.

ESCALATION CONDITIONS

- Backlog age or alarm breach persists for 15 minutes, or DLQ grows continuously.
- Candidate data is lost, duplicated, exposed, or rankings are materially incorrect.
- AWS quota/regional outage, unexpected cost spike, IAM/KMS issue, or security incident is suspected.

Recovery evidence to attach Alarm graph; job/message IDs; redacted logs; X-Ray trace; SQS/DLQ metrics; candidate ID; cost/retry note.